

Online ads crisis

A research suggests that 33 per cent of all online traffic is bogus, driving marketers crazy: <http://dgit.in/1hk0DKr>



Google cuts storage costs

In a step guaranteed to shake up the market, Google has drastically cut costs for its cloud storage service. <http://dgit.in/1oYr5ze>

Slash 4X was comparatively decent for a sub-₹10,000 tablet although we wish that the manufacturer had ironed out some of the minor lags it experiences. The tablet didn't manage to run high-end games smoothly and even crashed on a few occasions. Games like Temple Run 2 and Angry Birds seemed to work just about fine. HD video playback and other multimedia content didn't show any issues and everything was smooth. There is calling facility on the tablet and it works perfectly fine with clear audio quality.

BUILD AND DESIGN

A high quality design and an attractive look has become a crucial factor for gadgets these days. A very general rule implies here, higher the price better the quality. Tablets have gone much slimmer and much more portable than what they used to be a couple of years back and with such high competition, manufacturers have been producing tablets with a premium finish at an affordable price.

In the build and design test, we have rated each tablet based on a number of things like the quality of material, placement of keys, the responsiveness of the display, portability and also the aesthetics of the tablet.

The iberry Auxus CoreX8 proved to be the most powerful tablet in our performance test and to be honest it has a fairly good looking design. It does resemble a lot to the design philosophy that Samsung uses with its tablets and smartphones with a curvy design and glossy plastic finish. It has a 7.8 inch display and offers more of a 4:3 ratio. The home key is a proper hardware key which is a bit low on quality as it wiggles about. The settings and back key are capacitive placed on either sides of the home key. The tablet offers a proprietary charging port and can be charged via the standard microUSB port as well. The back is all glossy plastic and houses the 5MP camera.

The Windows 8.1 running Acer Iconia W4 has a very standard tablet design which can fool you very easily as it offers a brushed metal finish, but the tablet is actually made of plastic. It weighs about 430 grams which makes it feel a little heavy although it seems pretty compact due to its 10mm thickness. The 8 inch display offers a resolution of 1280x800 pixels. The screen is bright and vibrant and offers good viewing angles too. Overall Acer has done



Micromax Canvas Tab

a good job with the Iconia W4 however we must confess that 8 inch displays seem too small when using the desktop mode.

Both of the Dell Venue tablets have an exactly similar design and even the placement of the volume and power/lock keys, is similar. The back has nice rubberized finish which brings a really nice grip to the tablets. The only difference in the looks department is the size as the Venue 7 is smaller than the Venue 8. Apart from the screen size, one cannot tell these two apart. The overall finish of the tablets is exceptionally good and loved the display, even though it isn't full HD.

The Dell Venue 8 Pro Window tablet shares its design with its Android siblings and has the exact form factor as the Venue 8. The only difference is that the Venue 8 Pro has a different texture at the back. Apart from the screen size issue on Windows tablets we addressed earlier, we weren't happy with the placement of the Windows start key. One has to reach all the way for the edge; which is less than ideal.

One of our favourite tablets was the Google Nexus 7 (2013) and although it isn't one of the flashiest looking tablets, it is the most practical. The 7 inch IPS panel is crisp and has a full HD resolution which means it has

the highest ppi among all the tablets that we tested. The design is pretty slim and makes it easy to carry in the back pocket of your jeans. The 2013 version is a great update from last year's Nexus 7 as it is way more sleek and faster. The Nexus 7 was the slimmest tablet with a thickness of just 8.7mm.

The Micromax Canvas Tab looks a lot like a stretched out version of the Canvas Doodle 2. It has a nice strong back which gives off a metal finish, but isn't entirely made out of metal. Although we did love the quality of its external casing. The 8-inch display has a 1024x768 pixel resolution giving it 160ppi pixel density. Content on the display



Google Nexus 7 (2013)

lack details and the display itself is reflective. The viewing angles are good but we wish the resolution was better. The Canvas Tab is the second tablet in the shootout which offers a display with a 4:3 ratio. The ratio is not a problem when browsing the web or playing games, but when you watch HD videos, there is a waste of real estate as we know HD videos have a widescreen



Dell Venue Pro